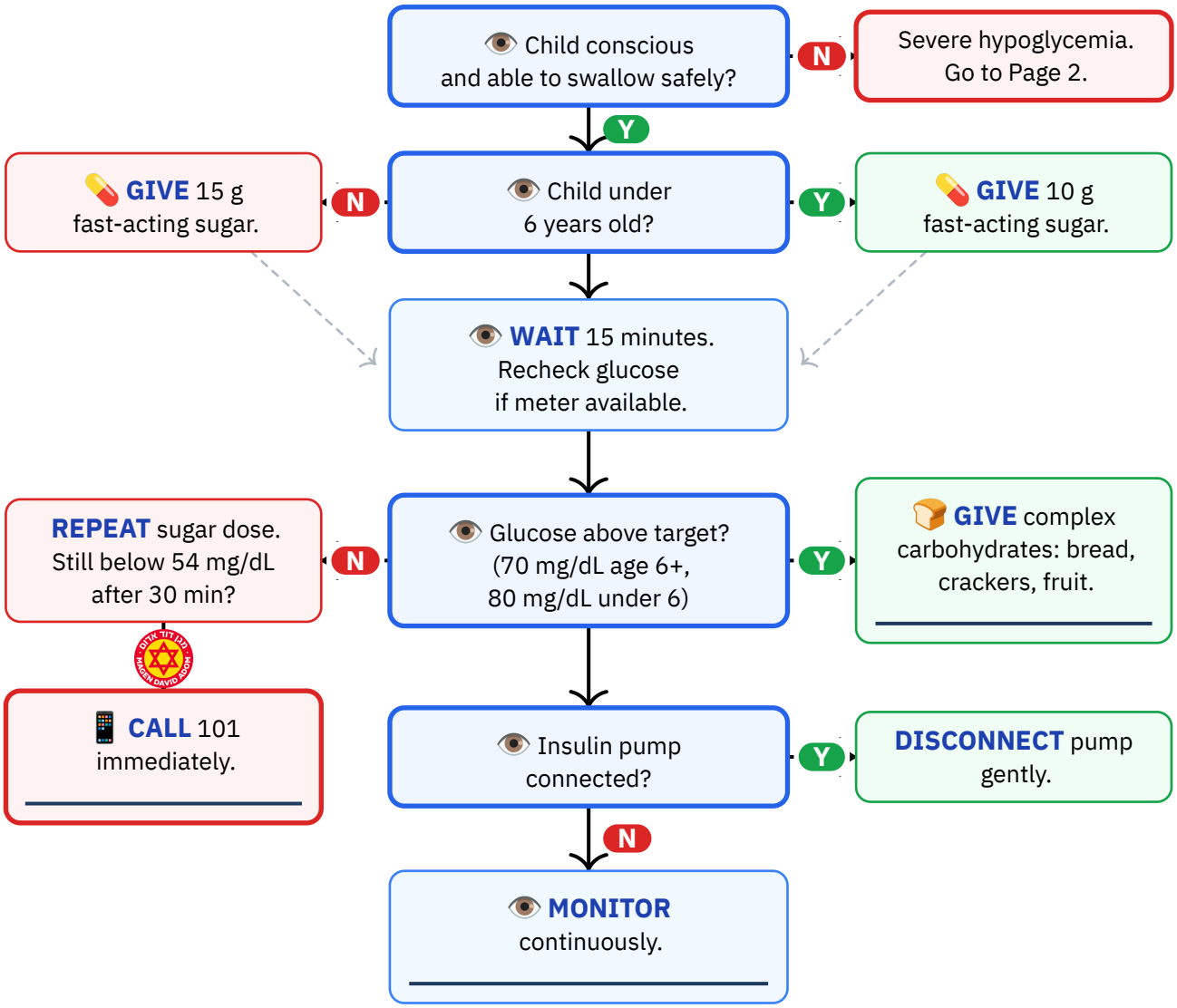

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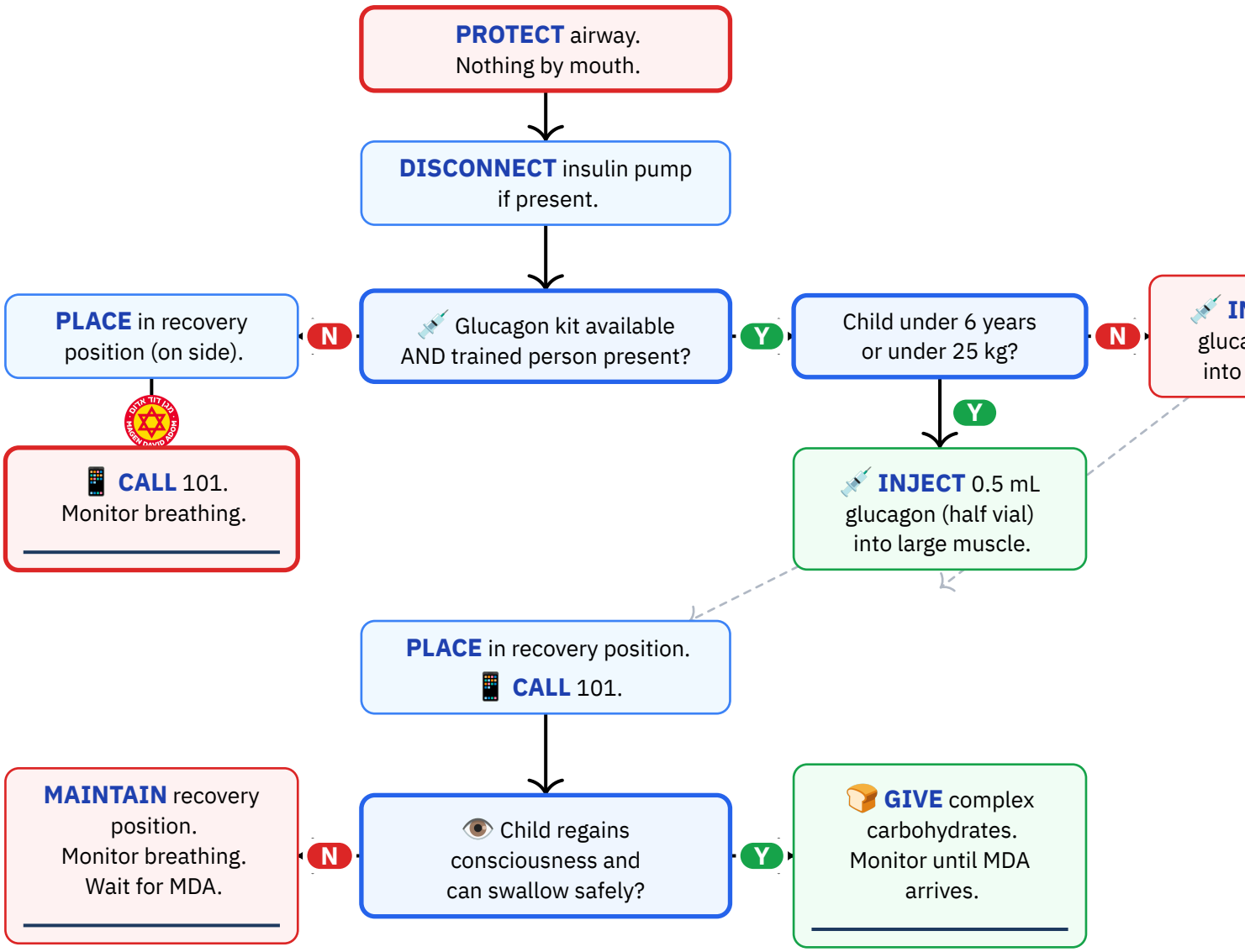
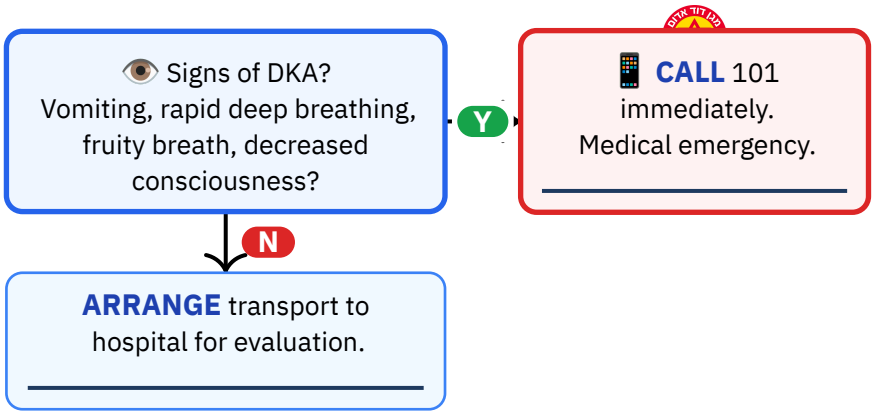
Severe Hypoglycemia — Unconscious / Seizing



DKA Assessment & Uncertainty Rule



When in Doubt — Give Sugar

If uncertain whether hypoglycemia or hyperglycemia: **give sugar**.

Sugar for a hypoglycemic child is life-saving.
Sugar for a hyperglycemic child will not cause immediate harm.
Withholding sugar from a hypoglycemic child can be fatal.

This applies only when the child is conscious and can swallow safely.

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Reference Notes

DO NOT:

- ✕ **Do NOT administer insulin** — this is strictly a medical intervention and can be fatal if given inappropriately.
- ✕ **Do NOT give food, drink, or oral medication to an unconscious or seizing child** — choking hazard.
- ✕ **Do NOT use chocolate as the initial sugar source** — fat and protein slow absorption and delay correction.
- ✕ **Do NOT administer glucagon unless trained and authorised** to do so.
- ✕ **Do NOT delay calling 101** for severe hypoglycemia, seizures, or loss of consciousness.
- ✕ **Do NOT attempt to manage hyperglycemia or DKA with first aid** — requires medical intervention.
- ✕ **Do NOT use diet drinks or sugar-free products** as a sugar source.

Equipment needed:

— Glucose gel syringe (15 g glucose)
— Fast-acting sugar source (juice, glucose tablets, sugar cubes, honey)
— Complex carbohydrate snack (bread, crackers, fruit)
— Glucagon emergency kit (Hypo-Kit) if available and authorised
— Blood glucose meter (glucometer) if available

Hebrew Terminology — מונחים בעברית

English	עברית	Pronunciation
Diabetes	סוכרת	su-KE-ret
Low blood sugar	סוכר נמוך	SU-kar na-MUKH
High blood sugar	סוכר גבוה	SU-kar ga-VO-ah
Sugar	סוכר	SU-kar
Glucagon	גלוקגון	glu-ka-GON
Insulin pump	משאבת אינסולין	mash-E-vet in-su-LIN
Seizure	פרכוס	pir-KUS
Unconscious	חסר הכרה	kha-SAR ha-ka-RA
Sweet drink	שתייה מתוקה	shti-YA me-tu-KA
Ambulance	אמבולנס	am-bu-LANS
Emergency	חירום	khe-RUM
Does the child have diabetes?	יש לילד סוכרת?	yesh la-YE-led su-KE-ret?

Source: Magen David Adom (MDA) — How to Treat a Diabetes Patient
URL: https://www.mdais.org/101/diabetes
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